

SUBSCRIBER HELP · REVIEW & CONCEPT

Every subscriber, to the right place, first time.

A review of how DC Thomson subscribers find help today, a concept showing reChanneld on your existing website, with nothing redesigned, and an 8-week pilot to prove it on one title.

01 Summary	02 DC Thomson today	03 Subscriber journey review	04 reChanneld on your site
05 Routing & cancellations	06 Subscriber video	07 8 – week pilot	+ Concept on your site (separate PDF)

Dear DC Thomson team,

Your subscribers are loyal. The DC Thomson Shop scores 4.8 out of 5 on Trustpilot, and some of your titles have been part of readers' lives for generations. Growing digital subscriptions is now central to your transformation, and every subscriber you keep counts towards that.

We looked at how a subscriber finds help today, as someone whose Saturday paper didn't arrive or who wants to change how they pay. The help exists: a help centre, My Account, and teams who clearly care. **But subscribers aren't guided to it.** On dcthomson.co.uk the only subscriber action we could find is a cancellation form. Readers choose between four phone lines with different opening hours, and the same few questions keep coming back.

reChanneld is channel-strategy software from Helsinki. It gives every title one “How can we help?” front door that shows each subscriber the fastest route for their need: self-service, a guide, a form or the right team. It sits on top of the systems you already have.

Rather than describe it, we've done some of the work:

1

Journey review

10 findings and a scorecard of today's subscriber help experience.

2

Concept on your own site

Your real pages, unchanged, with one reChanneld layer added and 9 annotated ideas.

3

Pilot plan

8 weeks on one title, with clear KPIs, so you can decide with your own data.

We'd love 20 minutes with your customer experience or subscriptions lead to walk through it and hear where subscriber help hurts most today.

Kind regards,

Touko Laakkonen

Service Channel Strategy, reChanneld · [e-mail] · [phone]

A transformation built on subscribers

A family business with a 200-year heritage, now putting money into technology, data and AI to grow digital subscriptions and B2B products.

£41M

subscription revenue, FY to Mar 2025 (+1%)

50,000+

paying subscribers to regional news titles

75,000

the earlier digital-subscription target for 2025

4.8/5

Trustpilot score for the DC Thomson Shop

Recent milestones

- **FY 2025** Revenue level at ~£134 M like-for-like, pre-tax profit £31 M, advertising +14%.
- **May 2025** Ella Dolphin appointed Deputy CEO, with a focus on M&A and transformation across the portfolio.
- **2025** Air Business renewed on a 3-year contract for subscription management.
- **May 2026** AI narration (BeyondWords × Pugpig) added to the Stylist and Press and Journal apps.
- **Now** Regional news subscribers past 50,000, still short of the 75,000 ambition.

What this means for subscriber help

- **Keeping subscribers counts as much as winning them.** Each frustrated subscriber is a churn risk on the £41 M line.
- **The portfolio is broad.** News, magazines, kids and puzzles each have their own readers, and one set of help rules across all of them would save effort.
- **You buy focused tools.** The AI narration shows you add specialist partners rather than rebuild your platforms. reChanneld fits that pattern.
- **Your systems are already in place.** Air Business, My Account and the help centre stay. What's missing is the guidance layer that connects subscribers to them.

The opportunity: make the help you already have the first thing every subscriber finds.

Finding help today: 10 findings

Reviewed as a subscriber with a missing paper or a billing question, 2 October 2026. These scores are our view.

2/10

FINDING HELP

3/10CLEAR CONTACT
ROUTES**3/10**SELF-SERVICE
SIGNPOSTING**4/10**OUT-OF-HOURS
HELP**3/10**OPTIONS AT
CANCELLATION**9/10**SUBSCRIBER
TRUST

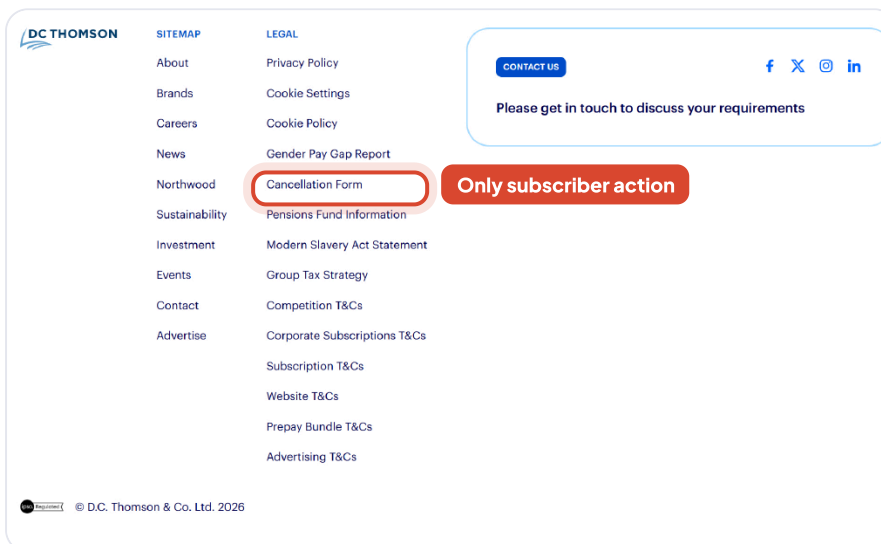
01 No path for subscribers in the main navigation **CRITICAL**

The menu serves advertisers, investors, job seekers and partners: About, Brands, Careers, News, Northwood, Sustainability, Investment, Events, Contact and Advertise. There's no "Help" or "My subscription".

→ A "Subscriber help" launcher on every page. No change to your navigation is needed.

02 The one subscriber action in the footer is "Cancellation Form" **CRITICAL**

It sits among the legal links, with no "Manage", "Pause" or "Report a missing issue" next to it. Cancelling is the easiest subscriber action to find.



→ Keep the link where it is. When it's clicked, show pause, switch and talk options first, with cancel still one click away.

03 The Contact box is written for business enquiries **HIGH**

"Please get in touch to discuss your requirements" suits an advertiser. A reader with a missing issue doesn't recognise themselves in it.

→ When the Contact box is clicked, ask "How can we help?" and route subscribers, advertisers and press separately.

04 Four phone lines, chosen by title and topic **HIGH**

Courier digital, Press and Journal digital, home delivery and the magazine shop each have their own number. The subscriber has to do the routing.

→ Ask for the title and topic, then show the right route, and the right number if a call is needed.

03 · SUBSCRIBER JOURNEY REVIEW, CONTINUED

05 Different hours on each line, and none on Sundays **HIGH**

News digital lines are open Mon–Fri 8–18 and Sat 9–17. The magazine shop is open Mon–Fri 9–17. A reader who finds a problem on a Sunday evening has nowhere to go.

→ **Self-service options available around the clock, with today's opening hours shown on the phone option.**

06 The same questions keep coming back **MEDIUM**

Despite the 4.8/5 rating, negative reviews cluster around late or missing issues, monthly vs quarterly billing, refunds and early renewal reminders.

→ **Make these the top self-service tasks, available in two clicks.**

07 Self-service exists but isn't signposted **MEDIUM**

There's a help centre and My Account through Air Business, but the corporate homepage doesn't lead to either.

→ **The launcher links straight to the right help-centre article or My Account page.**

08 Brand cards lead to brand pages, not to help **MEDIUM**

A People's Friend or Puzzler reader who clicks their title arrives at the brand story, not at subscriber help.

→ **Add the same launcher to each title's own site and app. Every brand keeps its design.**

09 Cancellation is shown without alternatives **MEDIUM**

Some subscribers who cancel only want a break, a cheaper option or a problem fixed. From the footer, they're offered only the form.

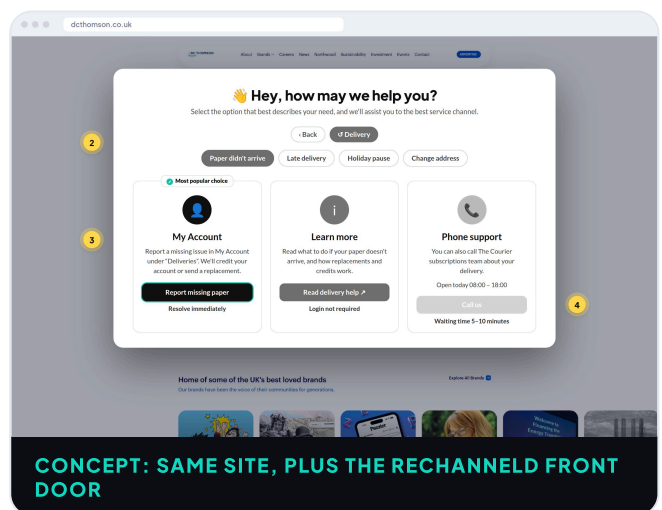
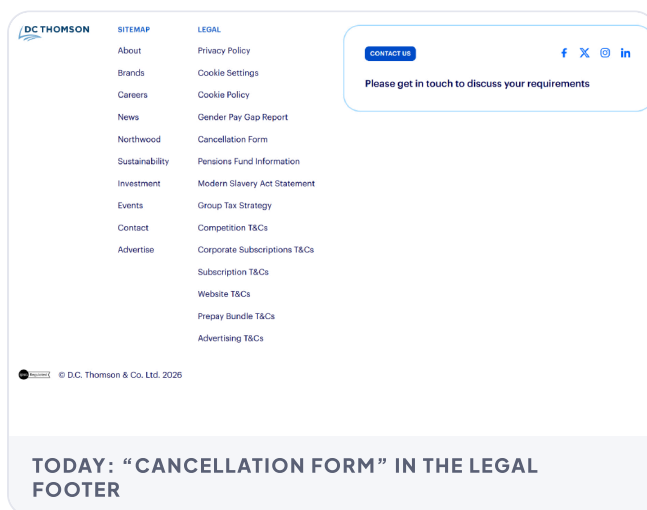
→ **reChanneld shows pause, switch to digital and talk to us next to cancel. Cancel stays one click away.**

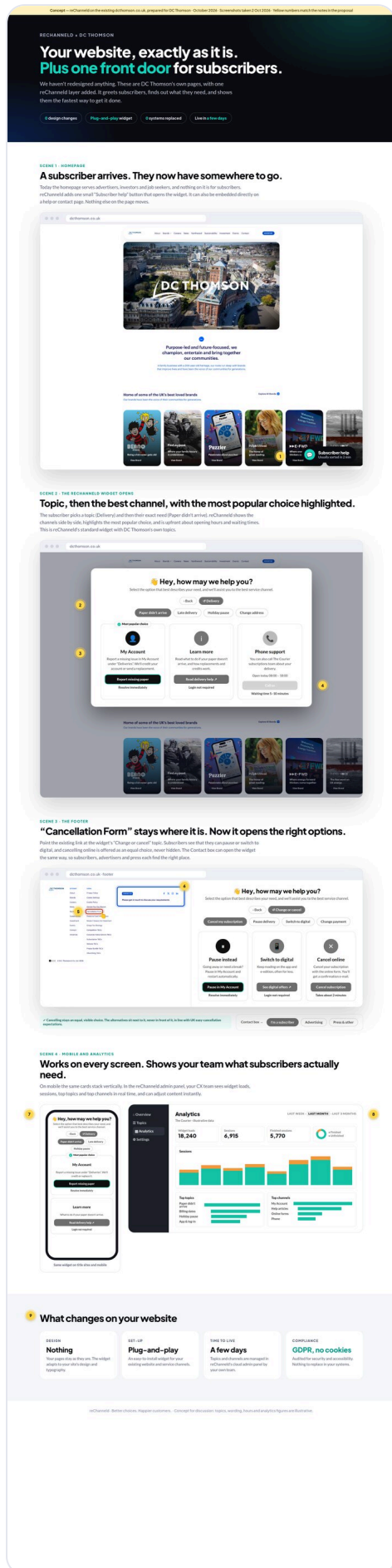
10 No wait times before you call **LOW**

Subscribers can't see whether a line is open or busy until they dial.

→ **Show opening hours and the typical waiting time on the phone option, as reChanneld does today.**

Before → after





Your website, exactly as it is. Plus one front door.

We haven't redesigned anything. The concept uses screenshots of dcthompson.co.uk as it is today, with one reChannelled layer added. The full page is in [reChannelled-DC-Thomson-Help-Concept.pdf](#), and each yellow number matches a note below.

- 1 A "Subscriber help" button** opens the reChannelled widget. It can also be embedded on a help or contact page. Your homepage stays as it is. Fixes 01 and 07.
- 2 Topics and sub-topics.** "Delivery" → "Paper didn't arrive", "Late delivery", "Holiday pause"... built from DC Thomson's own contact reasons. Fixes 06.
- 3 "Most popular choice".** The recommended channel, here My Account, is highlighted, with "Resolve immediately" underneath. Fixes 07.
- 4 Phone support, honestly.** Today's opening hours, the typical waiting time, and the right number for that title. Fixes 04, 05 and 10.
- 5 "Cancellation Form" stays where it is.** It opens the widget's "Change or cancel" topic: pause, switch to digital, or cancel online as an equal choice. Fixes 02 and 09.
- 6 The Contact box opens the widget too,** so subscribers, advertisers and press each find the right place. Fixes 03.
- 7 Mobile and title sites.** The same widget, with cards stacked on mobile. Separate widget configurations can serve different titles. Fixes 08.
- 8 reChannelled analytics.** Widget loads, sessions, finished sessions, top topics and top channels, in real time.
- 9 What changes:** no design changes, a plug-and-play widget, live in a few days, GDPR compliant with no cookies.

Why no redesign

Your site already looks good and is built for many audiences. reChannelled doesn't compete with it. It adds the missing subscriber path on top, so it can go live in a few days and be tested on one title first. The widget adapts to your site's design and typography.

Proposed starting rules

Built from public reviews and contact pages. In a pilot, your own contact data sets the final rules.

SUBSCRIBER TOPIC	ROUTE FIRST TO	WHY
Paper or magazine didn't arrive	Self-service	A recurring complaint. A form plus an automatic credit or replacement takes 2 minutes, 24/7, with no call needed.
Billing date or frequency	My Account	Shows the payment schedule clearly and prevents the monthly vs quarterly surprise behind several complaints.
Holiday pause / address change	Self-service	Simple, high volume and seasonal. It takes the pressure off before summer and Christmas.
App, e-edition or log-in	Guide	Step-by-step instructions by device, with phone as the fallback.
Renewal timing and reminders	My Account	Lets subscribers choose when and how they're reminded, answering the "too early" complaint.
Refund or complaint	Form – team	The form collects every detail up front, so the team can resolve it in one go.
Cancel or downgrade	Options + team	Pause and switch to digital shown next to cancel online, as equal choices. Phone remains available.

Cancellation, done right

UK subscription rules point towards cancellation being as easy as signing up. We agree: blocking cancellation damages trust and invites complaints.

What a front door can do is **offer the right alternative at the right moment**: a pause for the reader who's going away, a cheaper digital option for one watching costs, and a phone call for one with a problem. Cancel always stays one click away.

How it's managed

- **Topics and sub-topics** mirror how subscribers describe their need
- **Channel cards** per topic, with text, buttons, opening hours and waiting times
- **"Most popular choice"** marks the recommended route
- **Instant changes** in the cloud admin panel, with AI assistance on Pro and Enterprise plans
- **Several widget configurations**, e.g. one per title group

“Sorted in two minutes”: a 45-second help video

New help routes only work if subscribers know about them. A short, friendly video can sit in the help centre, renewal e-mails, the app and title social channels. It's made once, with a version for each title.

0:00–0:06 Saturday morning ☕ Doorstep... no paper 📰 ? VISUAL A reader opens the door: no Courier today. <i>“Paper didn’t turn up? We’ve all been there.”</i>	0:06–0:16 📱 “Help & subscriptions” → The Courier → Missing paper VISUAL On her phone: pick the title, pick the topic. <i>“Just tell us your title and what’s wrong.”</i>	0:16–0:26 ✓ Reported · credit added 1 min 48 s VISUAL Done before the kettle boils. <i>“Sorted in two minutes, any day, any time.”</i>
0:26–0:34 ⏸ Pause · 💷 Billing · 📱 App VISUAL Quick montage of the other top tasks. <i>“Holidays, billing, app help: it’s all there.”</i>	0:34–0:40 ☎ The right team, first time VISUAL A friendly agent with an older reader on the phone. <i>“And when you’d rather talk, we’ll put you straight through to the right person.”</i>	0:40–0:45 [Title] · Help & subscriptions yourtitle.co.uk/help VISUAL End card in the title's own branding. <i>“Help and subscriptions. We’re here for you.”</i>

Formats

16:9 for the help centre, 9:16 for social and the app, a 15-second e-mail cut and a GIF. Captioned for viewing without sound.

Per title, from one master

The same story with different end cards and voice-over lines for The Courier, Press and Journal, People's Friend and more. One production, many versions.

Prove it on one title, with your own data

The suggested pilot title is The Courier: a high-volume news title with a dedicated subscriptions line.

WEEKS 1–2

Map

Review three months of contact reasons, agree the topics, channels and wording, and set the baseline. The widget itself can be live within a few days.

WEEKS 3–8

Guide

The widget runs on The Courier's help pages and links from subscriber e-mails. Wording and recommended channels are adjusted in real time from the analytics.

WEEK 9

Decide

Review the results together, then decide on a rollout to other titles in priority order.

What we'll measure

KPI	HOW
Calls per 1,000 subscribers	Phone data, before vs during
Top channels chosen per topic	reChanneld analytics
Finished sessions	reChanneld analytics
Missing-issue handling time	Form to resolution
Cancellations converted to pause/switch	Choices in the cancel flow
Subscriber complaints by topic	Your CX data, before vs during

Who does what

reChanneld

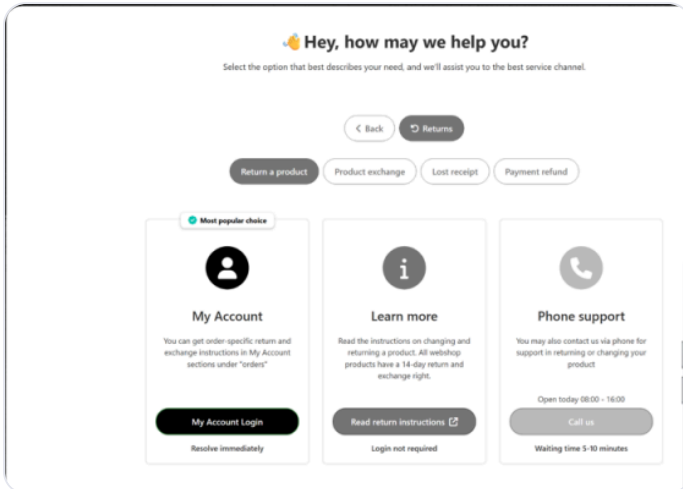
- Set-up, routing rules and copy
- Analytics access and weekly check-ins
- Content adjustments and a final report

DC Thomson

- One CX contact, about 2 hours a week
- Three months of contact-reason data
- Adding the front door to The Courier's help pages

No new chatbot, no CRM change, and no change to Air Business. If it doesn't show results in 8 weeks, you stop.

Better choices. Happier customers. Lower costs.



The reChanneld widget as it works today: topic, sub-topic, channel cards and the “Most popular choice”.

reChanneld is a channel strategy platform from Helsinki, Finland. A plug-and-play widget uses behavioural economics and digital nudges to guide customers to the best service channel. Customer service teams manage it themselves in a cloud admin panel, and it works on top of their existing website and channels.

4M+

annual sessions

79%

channel selections to self-service, automation and leads

87%

of end users found reChanneld easy and clear

Days

to define and implement a channel strategy

“Within just a few days we were able to nail our service channel strategy with reChanneld. Nudges work excellently, and we offer a far more intuitive experience to our customers than before!”

Teresa Alander, Head of Operations, Lippu.fi (part of CTS Eventim)

Used by

S-Bank, Nets, Lippu.fi, PAM, Sportson, Laurea, Varha and Satakunta wellbeing services county. They cover banking, payments, ticketing, retail, education and the public sector.

Enterprise-ready

Audited for security and accessibility, GDPR compliant, no cookies. White-labelled to your brand.

Next step

A 20-minute call with your customer experience or subscriptions lead. We'll show a live demo of the widget and admin panel, walk through the concept on your site, and agree whether The Courier is the right pilot title.

Shall we take 20 minutes?

We'd love to hear how subscriber help works today, and where it hurts most.

Touko Laakkonen
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